

Justin Collins

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Professional Summary

Engineering and Developer Experience leader with extensive experience building internal platforms, CI/CD systems, and cloud infrastructure that improve engineering productivity and software delivery. Proven track record leading cross-functional technical initiatives, establishing engineering standards, and partnering with development, infrastructure, and platform teams to improve developer experience, reliability, and delivery velocity. Deep expertise in Kubernetes, AWS, Infrastructure-as-Code, CI/CD, developer tooling, and cloud-native platforms.

Technical Skills

Cloud Platforms:	AWS, Google Cloud Platform (GCP)
Containers & Orchestration:	Kubernetes, Docker, Helm
Infrastructure as Code:	Terraform, Crossplane
CI/CD & Developer Platforms:	GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, ArgoCD
Observability:	Datadog, Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry
Languages & Scripting:	Python, Go, Bash, PowerShell
Other Technologies:	Linux, REST APIs, Okta, Git, Windows Server
AI-Assisted Development:	Cursor, Claude

Professional Experience

Minted — Senior Software Engineer, DevEx

Remote • October 2024 – Present

Lead platform engineering initiatives focused on improving developer productivity, deployment consistency, and delivery reliability across engineering teams in a cloud-native environment.

- Drive technical direction for the **developer platform, partnering with platform, infrastructure, and application engineering teams** to prioritize developer pain points and establish reusable engineering standards.

- Mentor engineers and delegate technical work across platform initiatives, **facilitate technical design discussions and planning sessions, and present platform strategy and progress to engineering leadership** while incorporating feedback from internal developer customers.
- Architect and implement a **standardized CI/CD framework** that consolidates heterogeneous service pipelines and tooling (including Garden.io) into a unified architecture leveraging **Docker Buildx, Terraform, and Helm**.
- Design reusable pipeline templates and automation that enable consistent **build, packaging, and deployment workflows** across engineering teams.
- Lead the implementation and evolution of an internal **Service Catalog using Port**, establishing ownership metadata, service scorecards, and self-service service creation while developing golden paths that make recommended engineering practices easier to discover and adopt.
- Support containerized application delivery on **Kubernetes infrastructure running in AWS**.
- Implement service instrumentation to expose **Prometheus metrics integrated with Grafana dashboards**.
- Use **Terraform** to manage and scale AWS infrastructure supporting application workloads.
- Use **AI-assisted development tools** including **Cursor** and **Claude** to accelerate development, explore technical designs, and support implementation of platform initiatives.
- **Minted Leadership Development Program** — Completed year-long leadership development program focused on communication, coaching, feedback, influence, and leadership effectiveness.

Motion Industries — Site Reliability Engineer III

Remote • May 2024 – October 2024

Worked across infrastructure and engineering teams to modernize legacy systems and expand the company's cloud platform using Kubernetes and Infrastructure-as-Code.

- Led implementation of **Datadog observability tooling** across the organization.
- Migrated logs, metrics, and monitoring pipelines from legacy tools into Datadog.
- Built and managed **Google Kubernetes Engine (GKE) clusters using Terraform**.
- Partnered with development teams migrating **Cloud Run services into Kubernetes using Helm**.
- Helped establish foundational **Site Reliability practices and monitoring standards** across teams.

Zelis — Site Reliability Engineer

Remote • October 2023 – March 2024

Supported migration of a large web and API platform to Kubernetes while implementing GitOps-driven infrastructure and deployment workflows.

- Migrated Ruby on Rails applications from **EC2-based infrastructure to Kubernetes on AWS EKS**.
- Implemented GitOps workflows using **Terraform, ArgoCD, and GitHub Actions**.
- Built PR-based ephemeral environments for automated testing and validation.
- Migrated Datadog monitoring and observability configuration into **Terraform-managed infrastructure**.

RxBenefits — DevOps Engineer II

Birmingham, AL • August 2021 – October 2023

Designed and implemented infrastructure and CI/CD systems supporting a cloud-native microservices platform in AWS.

- Helped lead migration of company infrastructure from **EC2-based architecture to Kubernetes on EKS**.
- Built CI/CD pipelines using **ArgoCD and Argo Workflows** to support microservice deployments.
- Containerized legacy applications and deployed them using **Docker and Helm**.
- Implemented **OpenTelemetry instrumentation** for distributed observability across services.
- Built AWS infrastructure using Terraform including **RDS, DynamoDB, S3, ECR, Lambda, and Route53**.
- Performed proof-of-concept work for centralized logging using **Datadog**.
- Led adoption of **Crossplane for Kubernetes-native Infrastructure-as-Code**.

RxBenefits — Senior Systems Administrator

Birmingham, AL • December 2018 – August 2021

- Helped architect the organization's initial **AWS cloud infrastructure platform**.
- Led migration of legacy on-prem infrastructure to AWS.
- Migrated large MySQL databases and application servers into cloud infrastructure.
- Implemented **Okta identity platform** as the company's central identity provider.
- Introduced DevOps practices including **Git workflows, Terraform Infrastructure-as-Code, and Jenkins CI/CD pipelines**.

Earlier Experience: Jenkon — DevOps Engineer / SCM Manager · Casamba / SourceMed — Production Support Application Specialist / DBA Engineer · Daxko — Software & Systems Configuration Engineer